

Lecture 0

Intro

Carlo Prato

POLS W4732

This class

Game theory for social scientists

Designed as the second class in the PoliSci PhD sequence

Blending tools and methods with applications

Learning objectives

Familiarity with foundational concepts in Game Theory
Becoming a good consumer of formal political theory
Start incorporating formal reasoning into your research

Class Structure

2 weekly lectures

Lecture slides constitute the main material

Slides often based on papers

Problem Sets (graded) and applications (TA sessions)

Verification Tasks (10 mins quizzes)

Preliminary Outline:

- Formalism/Refresher on static games
- Repeated Games
- Bargaining
- Imperfect information (hidden action)
- Incomplete information (hidden information)
- Signaling
- Agency
- Career Concerns
- Cheap Talk
- Electoral Competition
- Autocratic Politics

Grading

7 Problem Sets worth 5% (except PS1 which is 4%) of final grade

- you are encouraged to discuss answers with each other
- you can submit in groups
- you **MUST** type answers

verification tasks (in class quiz), each 2%

Midterm (Oct 22), 21%

Final (TBD), 21%

No Electronics Policy

- No electronics in the classroom
- To support focused engagement during class, students may not use laptops, tablets, or other electronic devices with internet capabilities during class time.
- Students are strongly encouraged to take notes using pen and paper.
- I will provide printed handouts before each lecture so that students can follow the material, annotate examples, and work through problems without needing electronic devices. Phones and other devices should be silenced and put away before class begins.

Logistics

TR 2:40–3:55PM

Office Hour: Tuesday, 10:00–12:00, IAB 812 (Zoom optional)

Sign up online: <https://goo.gl/WhS3MR>

Email cp2928 [at] columbia.edu

Teaching Assistant

Seung Shin

Email ss5370 [at] columbia.edu

Office Hour: Friday 3:15–4:15

TA Section: Friday 2:10–3:00PM 606 Lewisohn

About Carlo

(North)West-Italy born and raised

Econ PhD from Northwestern

At times, a bit more assertive than intended

Learned English at 19 $\Rightarrow$ has an accent

- **SPEAK UP** if what I say is unclear!

About Seung

From Korea

Authoritarian politics and formal theory

On the job market this semester!!!??

Your feedback is really valued

Clarity of instruction and material

Pace of instruction (too fast/too slow)

Integration between lectures and sections

Sequence of topics

About you

Briefly introduce yourself to the class

Veteran of POLS4730?

Research interests?